

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent Application Publication

20250280187

Kind Code

A1

Publication Date

September 04, 2025

Inventor(s)

DASILVA; Deanan et al.

LENS MOUNT CALIBRATION MECHANISM FOR LARGE CAMERA

Abstract

Disclosed herein are system, apparatus, and method for accurately setting a focus flange depth and planarity of a camera lens. An aspect includes a lens housing with at least one camera lens, a camera body with an imaging plane, and a lens mount removably coupling the lens housing to the camera body via a coupling mechanism. At least one shim may be inserted between the lens mount and the camera body to adjust a depth, pitch, and yaw of the camera lens in the lens housing with respect to the imaging plane in the camera body. Each shim may comprise a body having an opening extending from an edge of the body to a center of the body. The opening of each shim is configured to receive the coupling mechanism such that the pitch and yaw may be adjusted without fully removing the lens housing from the camera body.

Inventors: DASILVA; Deanan (Malibu, CA), Graae; Michael (Brooklyn, NY), Guenther; Bryan (Tucson, AZ), Mongelli; John Michael Eric (Tucson, AZ), Bierman; Timothy John (Windsor, WI), McDermot; Logan Andrew (Marshall, WI)

Applicant: Sphere Entertainment Group, LLC (New York, NY)

Family ID: 89845798

Assignee: Sphere Entertainment Group, LLC (New York, NY)

Appl. No.: 19/211538

Filed: May 19, 2025

Related U.S. Application Data

parent US continuation 18734215 20240605 parent-grant-document US 12335590 child US 19211538

parent US continuation 17887307 20220812 parent-grant-document US 12058430 child US 18734215

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: H04N23/55 (20230101); H04N23/53 (20230101); H04N23/57 (20230101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC H04N23/55 (20230101); H04N23/53 (20230101); H04N23/57 (20230101);

Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS [0001] The present application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 18/734,215, filed August Jun. 5, 2024, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/887,307, filed Aug. 12, 2022, now U.S. Pat. No. 12,058,430, each of which is incorporated herein by reference in its entirety.

TECHNICAL FIELD

[0002] The present disclosure relates to a camera system having an external mechanism for accurately setting a focus flange depth and/or a focus flange planarity of a camera lens mount system. Specifically, the external mechanism is configured to calibrate a depth, a pitch, and a yaw of at least one camera lens with respect to an imaging plane in a camera body.

BACKGROUND

[0003] A camera is a device used to capture and record real-life images in the form of photographs and/or videos. In order to capture and record such images, cameras generally comprise a camera body and a camera lens. The camera lens passes light reflected from objects in the real world and focuses the light onto an imaging plane in the camera body that captures the focused light as an image. The image may then be used to generate a photograph or a frame in a high quality video stream. The camera body may also include processors to execute computer-readable instructions that control various operations of the camera and a memory storage to save the captured images. Some cameras may receive power from an external power source (e.g., via a wire connection to a power outlet) while other cameras may receive power from an internal power source (e.g., a built-in or attachable battery pack). Various components of the camera must be adjusted and/or improved over time in order to keep up with the constantly evolving demand for higher resolution photographs, higher quality videos, larger display screens, faster streaming speed, and so on.

BRIEF SUMMARY

[0004] Disclosed herein are system, apparatus, device, method and/or computer program product embodiments, and/or combinations and sub-combinations thereof for an external mechanism that accurately sets the focus flange depth and planarity of a camera's lens mount system. The external mechanism is configured to calibrate a depth, a pitch, and a yaw of at least one camera lens with respect to an imaging plane in a camera body.

[0005] In some embodiments, a system for accurately setting a focus flange depth and/or a focus flange planarity of a camera lens includes, among other things, a lens housing having a distal end, at least one camera lens positioned within the lens housing, a camera body having a front face and an imaging plane within the camera body, and a lens mount removably coupling the distal end of the lens housing to the front face of the camera body via at least one coupling mechanism. At least one shim is configured to adjust at least one of a depth, a pitch, and a yaw of the at least one camera lens in the lens housing with respect to the imaging plane in the camera body. Each shim includes, among other things, a body having at least one opening extending from an edge of the body to a center of the body. The at least one opening is configured to receive the at least one coupling mechanism.

[0006] In another embodiment, an apparatus for accurately setting a focus flange depth and/or a focus flange planarity of a camera lens includes, among other things, a body having an opening extending from an edge of the body to a center of the body. The opening is configured to receive a coupling mechanism coupling a distal end of a lens housing to a front face of a camera body. The body is configured to create a gap between the camera body and the lens housing to adjust at least one of a depth, a pitch, and a yaw of the camera lens positioned in the lens housing with respect to an imaging plane in the camera body.

[0007] In yet another embodiment, a method for accurately setting a focus flange depth and/or a focus flange planarity of a camera lens includes, among other things, partially loosening at least one coupling mechanism attaching a lens mount to a front face of a camera body, inserting a number of shims between the lens mount and the front face of the camera body, and adjusting the number of shims inserted between the lens mount and the front face of the camera body. The method partially loosens the at least one coupling mechanism such that the at least one coupling mechanism maintains contact with both the lens mount and the camera body while creating a gap between the camera body and the lens mount. The method inserts the number of shims such that an opening of at least one shim receives the at least one coupling mechanism. The method adjusts the number of shims inserted between the lens mount and the front face of the camera body to change at least one of a depth, a pitch, and a yaw of the camera lens positioned within a lens housing that is removably coupled to the camera body via the lens mount.

[0008] In some examples, the method adjusts the number of shims inserted along a y-axis of the camera body to adjust the pitch of the camera lens in the lens housing with respect to an imaging plane in the camera body.

[0009] In some examples, the method adjusts the number of shims inserted along an x-axis of the camera body to adjust the yaw of the camera lens in the lens housing with respect to an imaging plane in the camera body.

[0010] Descriptions provided in the summary section represent only examples of the embodiments. Other embodiments in the disclosure may provide varying scopes different from the description in the summary.

[0011] Further features and advantages, as well as the structure and operation of various aspects, are described in detail below with reference to the accompanying drawings. It is noted that the specific aspects described herein are not intended to be limiting. Such aspects are presented herein for illustrative purposes only. Additional aspects will be apparent to persons skilled in the relevant art(s) based on the teachings contained herein.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0012] The accompanying drawings, which are incorporated herein and form a part of the specification, illustrate embodiments of the present disclosure and, together with the description, further serve to explain the principles of the disclosure and to enable a person skilled in the arts to make and use the embodiments. It is noted that, in accordance with the standard practice in the industry, features are not drawn to scale. In fact, the dimensions of the features may be arbitrarily increased or reduced for clarity of discussion.

[0013] FIG. 1 illustrates a perspective view of an exemplary camera system including a camera body and a lens housing, according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0014] FIG. 2 illustrates a block diagram of an exemplary computer system used within the camera body illustrated in FIG. 1, according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0015] FIG. 3 illustrates a perspective view of the camera body with a lens mount, according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0016] FIG. 4 illustrates a perspective view of the lens housing with an exterior cover removed, according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0017] FIG. 5 illustrates a perspective view of the camera body with the lens mount removed, according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0018] FIG. 6A illustrates a frontal view of a coupling mechanism of the lens mount with all fasteners removed, according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0019] FIG. 6B illustrates a perspective view of the coupling mechanism of the lens mount with all fasteners inserted, according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0020] FIG. 7A and FIG. 7B illustrate exemplary configurations of a shim for adjusting a depth, a pitch, and a yaw of the lens housing with respect to the camera body, according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0021] FIG. 8 illustrates a side view of the camera system shown in FIG. 1, according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0022] FIG. 9 illustrates an exploded side view of the lens mount, the coupling mechanism, and a front face of the camera body, according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0023] FIG. 10 illustrates a perspective view of the lens mount with a sealing mechanism, according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0024] FIG. 11 illustrates a perspective view of the front face of the camera body with a groove for receiving the sealing mechanism of the lens mount, according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0025] FIG. 12A illustrates a side view of the lens mount, the coupling mechanism, and the front face of the camera body when no shims are inserted, according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0026] FIG. 12B illustrates a side view of the lens mount, the coupling mechanism, and the front face of the camera body when shims are inserted, according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0027] FIG. 13 shows a flow diagram illustrating a method for using the shim to adjust the pitch and the yaw of the lens housing with respect to the camera body, according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0028] In the drawings, like reference numbers generally indicate identical or similar elements. Additionally, generally, the left-most digit(s) of a reference number identifies the drawing in which the reference number first appears.

[0029] Aspects of the present disclosure will be described with reference to the accompanying drawings.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0030] In order for a camera system including a camera lens and a camera body to produce high resolution images for photographs and videos, the camera lens must focus the incoming light onto the focal point of the imaging plane or sensor in the camera body. This may require that a flange depth, pitch (i.e., tilt along a y-axis) and a yaw (i.e., tilt along an x-axis) of the camera lens mount to be adjusted after manufacture. In most cameras where the camera lens is removably attached to the camera body, a flange distance (i.e., distance along a z-axis between the camera lens and the imaging plane of the camera body) may be rotatably adjustable by a user. However, the adjustment of the pitch and the yaw of the camera lens are generally built-in to the camera body and not accessible to the user after manufacture of the camera is complete. Therefore, specialized technicians are needed, making the adjustment process complicated, costly, and inefficient. This is especially an issue for large cameras because slight misalignments of the camera lens may cause significant deviations in the focal point of light on the imaging plane of the camera body. Thus, an external mechanism is needed to allow users to accurately and efficiently adjust a focus of camera lens with respect to an imaging plane in a camera body after manufacturing of the camera is complete.

[0031] Embodiments described herein are directed to a camera system having an external mechanism for accurately setting a focus flange depth and/or a focus flange planarity of a camera's lens mount system. Specifically, the external mechanism is configured to allow a user to calibrate depth, pitch, and yaw of at the camera lens mount with respect to an imaging plane in a camera body after manufacture of the camera system is complete. The camera system of the present disclosure includes a lens housing having a distal end, at least one camera lens positioned within the lens housing, a camera body having a front face and an imaging plane within the camera body, and a lens mount removably coupling the distal end of the lens housing to the front face of the camera body via at least one coupling mechanism. In some embodiments, at least one shim may be inserted between the lens mount and the camera body to adjust a depth, pitch, and yaw of the camera lens in the lens housing with respect to the imaging plane in the camera body. A different number of shims inserted along the x- and y-axis of the camera body will adjust the depth, the pitch, the yaw, or a combination of depth, pitch, and yaw of the camera lens, accordingly. For example, three shims may be inserted at different positions along the x- and y-axis of the camera body to simultaneously adjust the depth, pitch, and yaw of the camera lens. Each shim may include a body having an opening extending from an edge of the body to a center of the body. The opening of each shim is configured to receive the at least one coupling mechanism such that the depth, pitch, and yaw may be adjusted without fully removing the lens housing from the camera body. This allows the user to quickly and efficiently adjust the depth, pitch, and yaw of the camera lens, thereby accurately focusing the camera to produce high resolution images without needing complex technical knowledge or service from a specialized technician.

[0032] FIG. 1 illustrates a perspective view of an exemplary camera system **100**, according to some embodiments of the present disclosure. In one embodiment, camera system **100** includes a camera body **105**, a lens housing **110**, and a power source **115**. Camera body **105** may include a handle **120** that allows a user to support, carry, or otherwise physically manipulate camera system **100**. It should be understood by those skilled in the art that other configurations and designs for handle **120** may be used to support camera system **100** in other embodiments of the present disclosure and not exhaustively disclosed herein. In some embodiments, power source **115** may be removably coupled to camera body **105** and configured to provide sufficient voltage to power operations of camera body **105**. For example, power source **115** may be a removable battery pack providing a DC voltage to camera body **105**. In another example, power source **115** may be a power outlet providing an AC voltage via a plug and wire connectable to camera body **105**. In other embodiments, power source **115** may be incorporated into camera body **105** and not removable by a user. For example, power source **115** may be a single use battery or a rechargeable battery positioned within camera body **105**.

[0033] Lens housing **110** may provide mechanical support for a number of camera lenses **125** positioned along a z-axis of lens housing **110**. Each camera lens **125** may be separated by a predetermined distance along the z-axis such that incoming light **130** is ideally focused on an imaging plane in camera body **105**. In some embodiments, the predetermined distance between each pair of lens **125** may be a number calculated to achieve a desired focus of incoming light **130** on the imaging plane. It should also be understood by those skilled in the art that the predetermined distance between each pair of lens **125** may be the same or different in various embodiments of the present disclosure. Furthermore, the predetermined distance between each pair of lens **125** may be manually or automatically adjustable in some embodiments of the present disclosure. Lens housing **110** may further include an exterior cover (not separately enumerated) that protects camera lens **125** from the external environment (e.g., dust, weather, debris, etc.).

[0034] In some embodiments of camera system **100**, lens housing **110** may be removably coupled to camera body **105**. This scenario allows a user to exchange one lens housing **110** including a certain configuration of camera lenses **125** that achieve a certain focus with another lens housing **110** including a different configuration of camera lenses **125** that achieve a different focus. In other

embodiments of camera system **100**, lens housing **110** may be attached to camera body **105** during the manufacturing process of camera system **100** such that a user cannot easily exchange one lens housing **110** with another lens housing **110** without disassembling camera system **100**. This scenario may provide a camera system **100** that is more robust (i.e., no possibility of users improperly connecting lens housing **110** to camera body **105**, resulting in “slop” in alignment) but less flexible in changing a desired focus of incoming light **130** on the imaging plane.

[0035] FIG. 2 illustrates a block diagram of an exemplary computer system **200** used within camera body **105** illustrated in FIG. 1, according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0036] Various embodiments may be implemented, for example, using one or more well-known computer systems, such as the exemplary computer system **200** shown in FIG. 2. One or more computer systems **200** may be used, for example, to implement any of the embodiments discussed herein, as well as combinations and sub-combinations thereof. The computer system **200** may be used to control various components of camera system **100**, including but not limited to various operations of components within camera body **105** and components within lens housing **110**.

[0037] In some embodiments, exemplary computer system **200** may include one or more processors **205**, a memory **210**, a power source **215**, one or more sensors **220**, one or more network connections **225**, one or more user interfaces **230**, and one or more computer readable mediums **235**. It should be understood by those skilled in the art that other embodiments of the present disclosure may have more components or less components than that listed herein. Each of these components may be coupled by bus **202**, which enables communication between various components of the exemplary computer system.

[0038] Bus **202** may be any known internal or external bus technology, including but not limited to ISA, EISA, PCI, PCI Express, NuBus, USB, Serial ATA or Fire Wire. Processors **205** (also called central processing units, or CPUs) may use any known processor technology, including but not limited to graphics processors (also called graphics processing units, or GPUs) and multi-core processors. In some embodiments, a GPU may be a processor that has a specialized electronic circuit design to process mathematically intensive applications. The GPU may have a parallel structure that is efficient for parallel processing of large blocks of data, such as mathematically intensive data common to computer graphics applications, images, videos, etc.

[0039] Memory **210** may include a main or primary memory and one or more secondary memories. In some embodiments, the primary memory may be volatile memory, such as cache memory, random access memory (RAM), SDRAM, ROM, etc. The primary memory may include one or more levels of cache that have stored therein control logic (i.e., computer software) and/or data. In some embodiments, the one or more secondary memories may be non-volatile memory, for example, a hard disk drive, optical disks, magnetic tape, floppy disks, flash drives, etc. The one or more secondary memories may include a removable storage drive that may interact with a removable storage unit by reading from and/or writing to the removable storage unit. It should be understood by those skilled in the art that the exemplary types of memories and devices listed herein are not exhaustive, and any other computer data storage devices may be used in other embodiments of the present disclosure.

[0040] Power source **215** may be DC voltage (e.g., battery pack) or AC voltage (e.g., wired power outlet), as described above. Sensors **220** may be any type of sensor that allows exemplary computer system **200** to perform operations of camera body **105**, including but not limited to image sensors, current sensors, temperature sensors, proximity sensors, etc. Network connections **225** may include transmitters and receivers that allow exemplary computer system **200** to form electrical communications with any combination of external devices, external networks, external entities, etc. For example, network connections **225** may allow computer system **200** to communicate with the Internet or other camera systems **100**. In some embodiments, this communication may occur over a communication path, which may be wired and/or wireless (or a combination thereof), and which

may include any combination of LANs, WANs, the Internet, etc. Control logic and/or data may be transmitted to and from computer system **200** via the communication path.

[0041] User interfaces **230** allow a user to communicate with exemplary computer system **200** and vice versa. In some embodiments, user interfaces **230** may include input devices that allow the user to input control commands to exemplary computer system **200** and display devices that allow exemplary computer system **200** to communicate information and status of operations of camera body **105** to the user. For example, input devices may be any known input device technology, including but not limited to a keyboard (including a virtual keyboard), pointing devices, mouse, track ball, and touch-sensitive pad or display, which allows the user to manually provide an input to exemplary computer system **200**. Display devices may be any known display technology, including but not limited to monitors and/or display devices using Liquid Crystal Display (LCD) or Light Emitting Diode (LED) technology. In some embodiments, display devices may be located on camera body **105** and allow exemplary computer system **200** to output information to the user.

[0042] Computer-readable medium **235** may be stored on memory **210** and contain instructions to processors **205** for operation of exemplary computer system **200**. In some embodiments, computer-readable medium **235** may include various instructions **240-260**. In one example, computer-readable medium **235** may include various instructions **240** for implementing an operating system (e.g., Mac OS®, Windows®, Linux). The operating system may be multi-user, multiprocessing, multitasking, multithreading, real-time, and the like. The operating system may perform basic tasks, including but not limited to: recognizing input from input devices of user interfaces **230**; sending output to display devices of user interfaces **230**; organizing files and directories on memory **210**; controlling accessory devices connected to camera body **105** (e.g., adjusting the predetermined distance between camera lens **125** in attached lens housing **110**), which can be controlled directly or through an I/O controller; and managing traffic on bus **202**. In another example, computer-readable medium **235** may also include various instructions **245** for establishing and maintaining network connections (e.g., software for implementing communication protocols, such as TCP/IP, HTTP, Ethernet, telephony, etc.). In another example, computer-readable medium **235** may further include various instructions **250** to perform power management based on information collected by sensors **220** (e.g., enter power saving mode when voltage from power source **215** falls below a threshold). In yet another example, computer-readable medium **235** may further include various instructions **260** to perform memory storage operations to store captured images to memory **210**. The exemplary instructions described herein are for illustrative purposes only and are not intended to be exhaustive. Those of ordinary skill in the art will recognize that various other types of instructions achieving different purposes may be included in computer-readable medium **235** in other embodiments of the present disclosure.

[0043] Exemplary computer system **200** may also be any of a personal digital assistant (PDA), desktop workstation, laptop or notebook computer, netbook, tablet, smartphone, smartwatch or other wearable, appliance, part of the Internet-of-Things, and/or embedded system, to name a few non-limiting examples, or any combination thereof.

[0044] Exemplary computer system **200** may be a client or server, accessing or hosting any applications and/or data through any delivery paradigm, including but not limited to remote or distributed cloud computing solutions; local or on-premises software (“on-premise” cloud-based solutions); “as a service” models (e.g., content as a service (CaaS), digital content as a service (DCaaS), software as a service (SaaS), managed software as a service (MSaaS), platform as a service (PaaS), desktop as a service (DaaS), framework as a service (FaaS), backend as a service (BaaS), mobile backend as a service (MBaaS), infrastructure as a service (IaaS), etc.); and/or a hybrid model including any combination of the foregoing examples or other services or delivery paradigms.

[0045] Any applicable data structures, file formats, and schemas in computer system **200** may be derived from standards including but not limited to JavaScript Object Notation (JSON), Extensible

Markup Language (XML), Yet Another Markup Language (YAML), Extensible Hypertext Markup Language (XHTML), Wireless Markup Language (WML), MessagePack, XML User Interface Language (XUL), or any other functionally similar representations alone or in combination. Alternatively, proprietary data structures, formats, or schemas may be used, either exclusively or in combination with known or open standards.

[0046] In accordance with some embodiments, a tangible, non-transitory apparatus or article of manufacture comprising a tangible, non-transitory computer useable or readable medium having control logic (software) stored thereon may also be referred to herein as a computer program product or program storage device. Such control logic, when executed by one or more data processing devices (such as the computer system **200**), may cause such data processing devices to operate as described herein.

[0047] Based on the teachings contained in this disclosure, it will be apparent to persons skilled in the relevant art(s) how to make and use embodiments of this disclosure using data processing devices, computer systems and/or computer architectures other than that shown in FIG. **2**. In particular, embodiments can operate with software, hardware, and/or operating system implementations other than those described herein.

[0048] FIGS. **3** and **4** illustrate perspective views of camera body **105** (see FIG. **3**) and lens housing **110** (see FIG. **4**) removably coupled together via a lens mount **320** (see FIG. **3**) to form camera system **100** illustrated in FIG. **1**, according to some embodiments of the present disclosure.

[0049] FIG. **3** illustrates a perspective view of camera body **105** with lens mount **320**, according to some embodiments of the present disclosure. In the embodiment of FIG. **3**, camera body **105** has a front face **305** with an opening **310**. An imaging plane **315** is positioned within camera body **105** and parallel to front face **305** such that imaging plane **315** is exposed to incoming light **130** through opening **310**. Imaging plane **315** may include sensors (e.g., imaging sensors, light sensors, color sensors, etc.) configured to capture an image from incoming light **130** through opening **310**. A lens mount **320** is coupled to front face **305** of camera body **105** via at least one coupling mechanism **325**. In the embodiment of FIG. **3**, four coupling mechanisms **325** are evenly spaced around a circumference of lens mount **320** and used to secure lens mount **320** to front face **305** of camera body **105**, each coupling mechanisms **325** utilizing a fastener and screw configuration, described in further detail with reference to FIGS. **6A** and **6B**. It should be understood by those skilled in the art that other embodiments of the present disclosure may include more or less coupling mechanisms **325** to secure lens mount **320** to front face **305** of camera body **105**. Furthermore, other embodiments of the present disclosure may utilize other fastening configurations, including but not limited to Velcro, epoxy, staples, nails, rail and groove, etc., to secure lens mount **320** to front face **305** of camera body **105**.

[0050] FIG. **4** illustrates a perspective view of lens housing **110** with an exterior cover removed, according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure. In the embodiment of FIG. **4**, lens housing **110** has a distal end **405** configured to be removably coupled to lens mount **320** illustrated in FIG. **3**. For example, lens mount **320** and distal end **405** may both be designed as rings of different sizes configured to receive each other. In the embodiment illustrated in FIGS. **3** and **4**, the ring of distal end **405** may be smaller than the ring of lens mount **320** such that lens mount **320** receives distal end **405** of lens housing **110**. Specifically, an interior circumference (not separately enumerated) of lens mount **320** may have a threaded insert configured to receive and rotatably couple a threaded screw on an exterior circumference **410** of distal end **405**. It should be understood by those skilled in the art that lens mount **320** and distal end **405** may be designed as other shapes and sizes in various embodiments of the present disclosure and not exhaustively disclosed herein. Furthermore, lens mount **320** and distal end **405** may have different coupling mechanism designs, such tab and indent configurations, ball and socket joints, and other types of mechanical connectors not exhaustively described herein.

[0051] Referring to FIGS. **3** and **4**, distal end **405** of lens housing **110** includes an opening **415**.

When lens housing **110** is removably coupled to camera body **105** via lens mount **320**, opening **310** in front face **305** of camera body **105** aligns with opening **415** of distal end **405** of lens housing **110** such that incoming light **130** travels through camera lens **125** in lens housing **110** and focuses on imaging plane **315** in camera body **105**. As shown in FIG. 3, lens mount **320** is configured to surround opening **310** and imaging plane **315** such that when lens housing **110** is removably coupled to camera body **105**, lens mount **320** creates a sealed environment for incoming light **130** to ensure that ambient light from the environment does not affect the image captured by imaging plane **315**.

[0052] In order to obtain high resolution images, it is preferable in some embodiments to focus incoming light **130** to a center of imaging plane **305** in camera body **105**. Therefore, in some embodiments, the user may desire to adjust a pitch (i.e., tilt along the y-axis) and a yaw (i.e., tilt along the x-axis) of lens housing **110** such that camera lens **125** better focuses incoming light **130** to the center of imaging plane **305**. Inserting shims at various locations between lens mount **320** and front face **305** of camera body **105** may allow for this adjustment to be done after the manufacturing process of camera system **100** has been completed. Shims will now be described in further detail with respect to FIGS. 5-12 below.

[0053] FIG. 5 illustrates a perspective view of camera body **105** with lens mount **320** removed, according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure. After removing lens mount **320**, FIG. 5 shows coupling mechanism **325** without any obstructions. FIGS. 6A and 6B illustrate enlarged views of coupling mechanism **325**, according to some embodiments of the present disclosure. Specifically, FIG. 6A illustrates a frontal view of coupling mechanism **325** with all fasteners removed, and FIG. 6B illustrates a perspective view of coupling mechanism **325** with all fasteners inserted, according to some embodiments of the present disclosure.

[0054] Referring to the embodiment illustrated in FIG. 6A, coupling mechanism **325** includes a top hole **605** located in a top portion **610** of coupling mechanism **325** and a bottom hole **615** located in a bottom portion **620** of coupling mechanism **325**. Referring to the embodiment illustrated in FIG. 6B, top hole **605** is configured to receive a first fastener **625** while bottom hole **615** is configured to receive a second fastener **630**. First fastener **625** is configured to fasten coupling mechanism **325** to front face **305** of camera body **105** (see FIG. 5) while second fastener **630** is configured to fasten coupling mechanism **325** to lens mount **320** (see FIG. 3). In some embodiments, first fastener **625** and second fastener **630** are screws. It should be understood by those skilled in the art that other types of fasteners not exhaustively listed herein may be used in other embodiments of the present disclosure. Furthermore, it should be understood by those skilled in the art that other configurations of top hole **605**, bottom hole **615**, first fastener **625**, and second fastener **630** may be implemented in other embodiments without deviating from the teachings of the present disclosure. For example, in another embodiment, first fastener **625** may fasten coupling mechanism **325** to lens mount **320** while second fastener **630** may fasten coupling mechanism **325** to front face **305** of camera body **105**.

[0055] Shims may be used to adjust the pitch and the yaw of lens housing **110** with respect to camera body **105**, as described in further detail below with reference to FIGS. 7A and 7B.

[0056] FIG. 7A and FIG. 7B illustrate exemplary configurations of a shim **700**. Referring to the embodiment illustrated in FIG. 7A, exemplary shim **700** may include a body **705** with a center **710** and a bottom edge **715**. An opening **720** may extend from center **710** of body **705** to bottom edge **715** of body **705**. Opening **720** is configured to receive second fastener **630** after shim **700** is slid downwards from top portion **610** of coupling mechanism **325** towards bottom portion **620** of coupling mechanism **325** (see FIGS. 6A and 6B). This allows shim **700** to be externally inserted between front face **305** of camera body **105** and lens mount **320** to adjust the pitch and the yaw without having to fully remove lens mount **320** from front face **305** of camera body **105**. For example, second fastener **630** coupling lens mount **320** to front face **305** of camera body **105** may be partially loosened to create a sufficient gap to insert shim **700** without fully disengaging lens

mount **320** from front face **305** of camera body **105**.

[0057] In some embodiments, opening **720** may be a circular shape such that body **705** of exemplary shim **700** is a horseshoe shape. However, it should be understood by those skilled in the art that opening **720** may be designed as any other shape (e.g., slits) capable of receiving second fastener **630** during the insertion process described above. In some embodiments, shim **700** may be inserted between front face **305** of camera body **105** and lens mount **320** to adjust the pitch and the yaw. However, it should be understood by those skilled in the art that shims **700** may also be inserted between distal end **405** of lens housing **110** and lens mount **320** to adjust the pitch and the yaw in other embodiments of the present disclosure. Furthermore, in various embodiments of the present disclosure, exemplary shim **700** may be made of various materials (e.g., Brass, Stainless Steel, Plastic) and have exemplary dimensions of 0.02", 0.01", 0.005", 0.001", 0.0005".

[0058] Referring to FIG. 7B, another exemplary configuration of shim **700** may include a handle **725** attached to an upper edge **730** of body **705**. Handle **725** may be shaped as a knob or any other suitable shape for a user to conveniently handle and manipulate shim **700** in various other embodiments of the present disclosure. Once shim **700** is inserted into position with opening **720** receiving second fastener **630** of coupling mechanism **325**, handle **725** is configured to extend into top portion **610** of coupling mechanism **325** such that handle **725** is accessible by a user after lens mount **320** is re-fastened to proximately abut front face **305** of camera body **105**. In some embodiments, shim **700** may be made of a flexible material, allowing handle **725** to be bent at an angle with respect to body **705** of shim **700** for easier access by a user.

[0059] It should be understood by those skilled in the art that the exemplary configurations of shim **700** shown in FIGS. 7A and 7B are for illustrative purposes only and not intended to be limiting on embodiments of the present disclosure. In other embodiments, different configurations with different shapes and dimensions for body **705**, opening **720**, and handle **725** may be used without deviating from the teachings of the present disclosure.

[0060] When exemplary shims **700** are inserted between front face **305** of camera body **105** and lens mount **320**, the gap created may allow pollutants from the ambient environment (e.g., dust, debris, weather, light, etc.) to enter opening **310** in front face **305** of camera body **105**, thereby affecting the image captured by imaging plane **315** (see FIG. 3). To prevent this issue, lens mount **320** may include a sealing mechanism in some embodiments of the present disclosure, which will now be described in further detail with reference to FIGS. 8-11 below.

[0061] FIG. 8 illustrates a side view of camera system **100** illustrated in FIG. 1, according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure. As shown in the embodiment of FIG. 8 and as explained above, lens mount **320** removably couples distal end **405** of lens housing **110** to front face **305** of camera body **105** via coupling mechanisms **325** (not illustrated). FIG. 9 illustrates an exploded side view of lens mount **320**, coupling mechanisms **325**, and front face **305** of camera body **105** (collectively "900"). When shims **700** are used to adjust the pitch and/or the yaw of lens housing **110** with respect to camera body, shims **700** may be inserted at position **920** between lens mount **320** and coupling mechanisms **325** such that opening **710** of shim **700** receives second fastener **630** of coupling mechanism **325** (see FIGS. 6A-7B). This insertion of shim **700** distances lens mount **320** away from coupling mechanism **325** and front face **305** of camera body **105** by a width of shim **700**. Since coupling mechanisms **325** are only located at a number of select points around the circumference of lens mount **320** (see FIGS. 3 and 5), inserted shims **700** will create a gap in assembled camera system **100** between lens mount **320** and front face **305** of camera body **105** at all locations around the circumference of lens mount **320** without a coupling mechanism **325**. This gap may potentially allow pollutants to enter opening **310** in front face **305** of camera body **105** and detrimentally affect the image captured by imaging plane **315** (see FIG. 3).

Accordingly, a sealing mechanism **915** is needed, as explained in further detail below with additional reference to FIGS. 10-11, respectively illustrating perspective views of lens mount **320** with sealing mechanism **915** (see FIG. 10) and front face **305** of camera body **105** with groove for

receiving sealing mechanism **915** (see FIG. **11**).

[0062] Referring to FIG. **9**, lens mount **320** may include a first side **905** configured to abut distal end **405** of lens housing **110** and a second side **910** configured to abut front face **305** of camera body **105** in assembled camera system **100** (also see FIG. **8**). Second side **910** of lens mount **320** may further include a sealing mechanism **915** protruding from second side **910**. Referring to FIG. **10**, in some embodiments, sealing mechanism **915** may be a ring extending the interior circumference of lens mount **320** on second side **910**. It should be understood by those skilled in the art that sealing mechanism **915** may be of a different shape or be located at a different location on second side **910** of lens mount **320** in other embodiments of the present disclosure not exhaustively described herein. Furthermore, it should be understood by those skilled in the art that sealing mechanism **915** may be made of different materials and have different dimensions in other embodiments of the present disclosure. For example, in some embodiments, sealing mechanism **915** may be a rubber gasket configured to keep dust and light from polluting the image captured by camera system **100**.

[0063] Referring to FIG. **11**, front face **305** of camera body **105** may include a groove **1105** configured to receive sealing mechanism **915**. In some embodiments, groove **1105** may be designed as a depression section set into front face **305** of camera body **105** and configured to receive sealing mechanism **915**. It should be understood by those skilled in the art that groove **1105** may be various mechanical configurations configured to receive scaling mechanism **915** in other embodiments of the present disclosure and not exhaustively listed herein. Front face **305** of camera body **105** may also include indents **1110** configured to receive coupling mechanisms **325**. Groove **1105** and indents **1110** work together to receive sealing mechanism **915** and coupling mechanisms **325**, respectively, so that even after shims **700** are inserted to adjust the pitch and/or the yaw, opening **310** remains sealed from potential environment pollutants, thus protecting the image captured by imaging plane **315**.

[0064] FIG. **12A** illustrates a side view of the collection of components **900** shown in FIG. **9** when no shims **700** are inserted at position **920**, whereas FIG. **12B** illustrates a side view of the collection of components **900** shown in FIG. **9** when shims **700** are inserted at position **920**, according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure. Referring to FIG. **12A**, when no shims **700** are inserted at position **920** between lens mount **320** and coupling mechanism **325**, second side **910** of lens mount **320** fully abuts front face **305** of camera body **105**, thus sealing opening **310** in front face **305** from any potential environment pollutants. In this scenario, indents **1110** in front face **305** fully receive coupling mechanisms **325** and groove **1105** in front face **305** fully receives scaling mechanism **915** of lens mount **320** (see FIGS. **10** and **11**).

[0065] On the other hand, referring to FIG. **12B**, when shims **700** are inserted at position **920** between lens mount **320** and coupling mechanism **325**, second side **910** of lens mount **320** is distanced away from front face **305** of camera body **105** by shim **700**. In this scenario, sealing mechanism **915** of lens mount **320** is partially removed from groove **1105** in front face **305** but maintains contact with groove **1105**. This allows sealing mechanism **915** to seal the gap that would otherwise be created between lens mount **320** and front face **305** of camera body **105**, thus preventing any potential environment pollutants from entering opening **310** in front face **305**. In order for sealing mechanism **915** to effectively seal the gap created by shims **700**, a height of sealing mechanism **915** must be greater than a collective depth of shims **700** inserted at one point around the circumference of lens mount **320**. It should be understood by those skilled in the art that the height of scaling mechanism **915** may be calculatedly different in various embodiments of the present disclosure without deviating from the teachings of the present disclosure. Furthermore, in various embodiments, the height of sealing mechanism **915** may be constant or change along the circumference of lens mount **320**. Variations in the mechanical design of scaling mechanism **915** understood by those skilled in the art do not deviate from the present teachings and are not exhaustively described herein.

[0066] FIG. 13 shows a flow diagram illustrating a method 1300 for using shims 700 to adjust the pitch and the yaw of lens housing 110 with respect to camera body 105, according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure. At step 1305, method 1300 partially loosens at least one coupling mechanism 325 attaching lens mount 320 to front face 305 of camera body 105. For example, as shown in the exemplary embodiment of FIG. 12B, method 1300 may partially loosen second fastener 630 of coupling mechanism 325 such that second side 910 of lens mount 320 is distanced away from abutting front face 305 of camera body 105. After creating a sufficient gap to fit a desired number of shims 700, step 1310 of method 1300 inserts a number of shims 700 between lens mount 320 and camera body 105. Specifically, as explained above with reference to FIGS. 6A-7B, each shim 700 may be externally inserted by sliding downwards from top portion 610 of coupling mechanism 325 towards bottom portion 620 of coupling mechanism 325 until opening 720 of shim 700 receives second fastener 630 of coupling mechanism 325. It should be understood by those skilled in the art that the number of shims 700 inserted by step 1310 of method 1300 may differ in various embodiments of the present disclosure depending on a user's desired amount of adjustment of the pitch and/or the yaw. In some embodiments, users may use resolution target charts to calibrate an optimal resolution in the x- and y-axis and insert a calculated number of shims 700 corresponding to the desired adjustment. Specific adjustment of the pitch vs. the yaw of lens housing 110 with respect to camera body 105 is described in further detail below.

[0067] At step 1315, method 1300 may adjust the pitch (i.e., tilt along the y-axis) of lens housing 110 with respect to camera body 105 by adjusting the number of shims 700 inserted along the y-axis of lens mount 320. For example, as shown in the embodiments of FIGS. 3 and 4, if incoming light 130 is focused on a point higher than the center of imaging plane 315, then lens housing 110 may be positioned at a depressed angle on the z-axis with respect to camera body 105. To adjust the pitch in this scenario, shims 700 may be inserted towards a bottom of lens mount 320 so that lens housing 110 will become level with respect to camera body 105 along the z-axis. Vice versa, if incoming light 130 is focused on a point lower than the center of imaging plane 315, then lens housing 110 may be positioned at an elevated angle on the z-axis with respect to camera body 105 and shims 700 may be inserted towards a top of lens mount 320 to adjust the pitch.

[0068] Similarly, at step 1320, method 1300 may adjust the yaw (i.e., tilt along the x-axis) of lens housing 110 with respect to camera body 105 by adjusting the number of shims 700 inserted along the x-axis of lens mount 320. It should be understood by those skilled in the art that method 1300 may execute steps 1315 and 1320 in isolation or in combination. Executing step 1315 or step 1320 in isolation allows the pitch to be adjusted but not the yaw, and vice versa. Executing a combination of step 1315 and step 1320 allows method 1300 to adjust a combination of both the pitch and the yaw of camera system 100. This allows a user 360° free adjustment of the alignment of lens housing 110 with respect to camera body 105 in the xy-plane until incoming light 130 is perfectly focused on the center of imaging plane 315, thereby allowing camera system 100 to generate higher resolution images for photographs and/or videos.

[0069] It should be understood by those skilled in the art that some operations of method 1300 described above may be performed in a different order and/or vary, and method 1300 may include more operations that are not described herein for simplicity.

[0070] The present disclosure has been described above with the aid of functional building blocks illustrating the implementation of specified functions and relationships thereof. The boundaries of these functional building blocks have been arbitrarily defined herein for the convenience of the description. Alternate boundaries can be defined so long as the specified functions and relationships thereof are appropriately performed.

[0071] The foregoing description of the specific embodiments will so fully reveal the general nature of the present disclosure that others can, by applying knowledge within the skill of the art, readily modify and/or adapt for various applications such specific embodiments, without undue experimentation, without departing from the general concept of the present disclosure. Therefore,

such adaptations and modifications are intended to be within the meaning and range of equivalents of the disclosed embodiments, based on the teaching and guidance presented herein. It is to be understood that the phraseology or terminology herein is for the purpose of description and not of limitation, such that the terminology or phraseology of the present specification is to be interpreted by the skilled artisan in light of the teachings and guidance.

[0072] The breadth and scope of the present disclosure should not be limited by any of the above-described exemplary embodiments but should be defined only in accordance with the following claims and their equivalents.

[0073] The claims in the instant application are different than those of the parent application or other related applications. The Applicant, therefore, rescinds any disclaimer of claim scope made in the parent application or any predecessor application in relation to the instant application. The Examiner is therefore advised that any such previous disclaimer and the cited references that it was made to avoid, may need to be revisited. Further, the Examiner is also reminded that any disclaimer made in the instant application should not be read into or against the parent application.

Claims

1. A method for adjusting a yaw and a pitch of a lens housing in a camera system, the method comprising: creating a gap between a lens mount of the camera system and a camera body of the camera system; inserting a plurality of shims into the gap along an x-axis and a y-axis defined relative to the lens mount; modifying a first number of shims inserted along the x-axis of the lens mount to adjust the yaw of the lens housing with respect to the camera body; and modifying a second number of shims inserted along the y-axis of the lens mount to adjust the pitch of the lens housing with respect to the camera body.
2. The method of claim 1, wherein the creating comprises partially loosening at least one coupling mechanism coupling the lens mount to the camera body such that the lens mount remains engaged with the camera body to create the gap.
3. The method of claim 2, wherein the partially loosening comprises loosening one or more fasteners such that the lens mount is moved without completely detaching from the camera body to create the gap.
4. The method of claim 2, further comprising re-tightening the at least one coupling mechanism after modifying the first and second number of shims to secure the lens mount to the camera body.
5. The method of claim 2, wherein the inserting the plurality of shims comprises positioning each shim from among the plurality of shims into the gap such that an opening of each shim receives a fastener of the one coupling mechanism.
6. The method of claim 1, wherein the modifying the first number of shims comprises adding or removing one or more shims at laterally opposed positions of the lens mount to rotate the lens housing about a vertical axis relative to the camera body to adjust the yaw of the lens housing with respect to the camera body.
7. The method of claim 1, wherein the modifying the second number of shims comprises adding or removing one or more shims at vertically opposed positions of the lens mount to rotate the lens housing about a horizontal axis relative to the camera body to adjust the pitch of the lens housing with respect to the camera body.
8. A method for adjusting a yaw and a pitch of a lens housing in a camera system, the method comprising: creating a gap between a lens mount of the camera system and a camera body of the camera system while maintaining engagement between the lens mount and the camera body; inserting a plurality of shims into the gap along an x-axis and a y-axis defined relative to the lens mount; modifying a first number of shims inserted along the x-axis of the lens mount to adjust the yaw of the lens housing with respect to the camera body; modifying a second number of shims inserted along the y-axis of the lens mount to adjust the pitch of the lens housing with respect to the

camera body; and securing the lens mount to the camera body after modifying the first and second number of shims.

9. The method of claim 8, wherein creating the gap comprises partially loosening one or more fasteners that maintain the engagement between the lens mount and the camera body.

10. The method of claim 9, wherein the partially loosening allows the lens mount to move relative to the camera body without fully detaching from the camera body.

11. The method of claim 8, wherein securing the lens mount to the camera body comprises re-tightening one or more fasteners after modifying the first and second number of shims.

12. The method of claim 8, wherein the inserting the plurality of shims comprises positioning each shim from among the plurality of shims into the gap such that an opening of each shim receives a fastener of the one coupling mechanism.

13. The method of claim 8, wherein modifying the first number of shims comprises adding or removing one or more shims at laterally opposed positions of the lens mount to rotate the lens housing about a vertical axis relative to the camera body to adjust the yaw with respect to the camera body.

14. The method of claim 8, wherein modifying the second number of shims comprises adding or removing one or more shims at vertically opposed positions of the lens mount to rotate the lens housing about a horizontal axis relative to the camera body to adjust the pitch with respect to the camera body.

15. A method for aligning a lens housing relative to a camera body of a camera system, the method comprising: positioning a lens mount between the lens housing and the camera body; forming a variable gap between the lens mount and the camera body; inserting a plurality of shims into the variable gap at locations distributed along orthogonal x-axis and y-axis directions relative to the lens mount; adjusting a distribution of the shims along the x-axis to correct yaw misalignment of the lens housing with respect to the camera body; and adjusting a distribution of the shims along the y-axis to correct pitch misalignment of the lens housing with respect to the camera body.

16. The method of claim 15, wherein forming the variable gap comprises partially loosening at least one coupling mechanism that couples the lens mount to the camera body, such that the lens mount remains engaged with the camera body during the formation of the gap.

17. The method of claim 16, wherein partially loosening the at least one coupling mechanism comprises loosening one or more fasteners to permit movement of the lens mount without fully detaching the lens mount from the camera body.

18. The method of claim 16, further comprising re-tightening the at least one coupling mechanism after adjusting the distribution of the shims to secure the lens mount to the camera body.

19. The method of claim 15, wherein adjusting the distribution of the shims along the x-axis comprises adding or removing one or more shims at laterally opposed positions of the lens mount to rotate the lens housing about a vertical axis relative to the camera body.

20. The method of claim 15, wherein adjusting the distribution of the shims along the y-axis comprises adding or removing one or more shims at vertically opposed positions of the lens mount to rotate the lens housing about a horizontal axis relative to the camera body.
